

Google Pixel 10

Compact flagship that thinks smarter, not faster

The question now isn't whether the Pixel can do clever things; we already know there's a lot on offer, but now it's whether it can do them faster, cooler, and more reliably than before.

DESIGN AND BUILD

The Pixel 10 carries forward Google's minimalist design DNA but feels more mature this year. At 204 grams, it's slightly heavier than the Pixel 9, but the added density works in its favour, lending it a reassuring, premium hand-feel. The 8.6 mm thickness doesn't make it bulky, and the balanced weight distribution ensures it sits comfortably during long one-handed use. The buttons are tactile, the haptics crisp, and the IP68 rating adds the expected layer of durability.

Google continues to use Gorilla Glass Victus 2 on both sides, making it resistant to scratches and minor drops. The only quirk here is the slightly raised camera bar, which still prevents the phone from lying perfectly flat, though the wobble has been reduced compared to last year's model. It looks distinctly "Pixel" while finally achieving the kind of craftsmanship you'd expect from a premium flagship.

DISPLAY

The Pixel 10 features a 6.3-inch OLED panel that finally feels flagship-grade. The display retains the familiar 2424×1080 pixels resolution but now delivers up to 3,000 nits of peak brightness, a noticeable leap from the Pixel 9's 2,700 nits. In daily use, it's bright enough to stay legible even under harsh



afternoon sunlight, and HDR playback in apps like YouTube and Netflix looks punchy without appearing oversaturated.

In our Calman tests, the panel achieved 100 per cent coverage of the sRGB colour gamut and excellent accuracy, with an average

Delta E of 2.0 and a maximum Delta E of 4.4 at the white point. That puts it among the most colour-accurate panels in its class, rivalling what you'd find on the Galaxy S25 or iPhone 17. The RGB balance chart shows a slight blue bias at full brightness, but nothing that affects everyday viewing.

The screen produces deep blacks and well-defined highlights, and HDR10+ certification ensures consistent tone-mapping across content. Google has also upgraded the colour depth, resulting in smoother gradients and fewer visible banding issues when watching HDR videos or editing photos.

The 120 Hz adaptive refresh rate feels responsive, although the panel still doesn't use LTPO technology, meaning it can't drop dynamically below 60 Hz. That's one area where the Pixel 10 trails pricier flagships, but in daily use, scrolling, gaming, or even simple animations, the fluidity feels top-tier.

Paired with stereo speakers that deliver clear mids and crisp highs, the Pixel 10 offers one of the most balanced multimedia experiences in this segment. Whether you're streaming Dolby Vision content or editing photos, the display feels tuned for accuracy.

PERFORMANCE & SOFTWARE

In synthetic benchmarks, the Pixel 10 shows measurable improvement across the board. It scored 1,165,176 on AnTuTu, a marginal bump over the Pixel 9's 1.16 million, but a more meaningful jump appears in Geekbench, where single-core scores rise from 1,654 to 2,043, and multi-core from 4,233 to 4,481.

These numbers still trail Qualcomm's Snapdragon 8 Gen Elite and Apple's A19, but they indicate that Google has finally closed the performance gap enough for everyday use to feel fluid and consistent.

The CPU throttling test saw the Pixel 10 maintain 59% of its peak performance only after 5 minutes, roughly the same as the Pixel 9, though the heat dispersion is more controlled this time. Productivity benchmarks back this up: the Pixel 10 logged 14,522 in PCMark Work, a significant leap from the Pixel 9's 10,997, showing clear optimisation for multi-tasking and real-world app performance. In 3DMark Wildlife, it achieved 3,104 points, again outpacing its predecessor's 2,568 but falling short of gaming-focused rivals like the iQOO 13 or OnePlus 13.

In practical terms, the Tensor G5 feels swift across most scenarios, such as launching apps, switching between tasks, or processing photos in the background. It's not the most powerful chip in its class, but it's finally efficient,